

Git + RStudio on Windows

Easy setup workflow for students

Goal

At the end, Git is installed, Windows can find it, and RStudio can use it.

Part 1. Install Git

1

Check whether Git is already installed

Open **Command Prompt** from the Windows Start menu and run:

```
git --version
```

If you see a Git version number, Git is installed. Skip to Step 3. If Windows says Git is not recognized, continue to Step 2.

2

Install Git for Windows

Download **Git for Windows** from <https://git-scm.com/download/win> and run the installer.

Important installer choice: when asked about PATH, choose "**Git from the command line and also from 3rd-party software**". Otherwise, accept the default choices.

Leave Git in its normal location under **C:\Program Files\Git**.

3

Close and reopen RStudio

If RStudio was open while Git was installed, **quit RStudio completely** and reopen it. RStudio needs to start after Git is available on the system.

Part 2. Check that RStudio can find Git

4

Test from the RStudio Console

In the RStudio **Console**, run:

```
Sys.which("git")
```

Good: you get a path to `git.exe`.

Problem: you get only `""`. If that happens, use the troubleshooting page.

5

Check RStudio's Git executable setting

Go to **Tools > Global Options > Git/SVN**. Look at **Git executable**.

On a standard Windows install, set it to:

```
C:/Program Files/Git/bin/git.exe
```

Use `bin/git.exe`. Do not choose `git-bash.exe`.

6

Restart RStudio, then do a final check

Restart RStudio after changing the Git executable. Then check:

File > New Project... - you should see **Version Control** as an option.

You can also run `Sys.which("git")` again. A non-empty path means R can find Git.

Troubleshooting: Git is installed but RStudio cannot find it

Use the first section that matches what you see.

A. Sys.which("git") returns ""

1	Fully quit and reopen RStudio. If that does not work, restart Windows once.
2	Open Command Prompt and run <code>where git</code> and <code>git --version</code> .
3	If Command Prompt also cannot find Git, rerun the Git for Windows installer and make sure the PATH option is "Git from the command line and also from 3rd-party software" .
4	If needed, check Windows Environment Variables > Path . A typical Git entry is <code>C:\Program Files\Git\cmd</code> . After changing PATH, restart RStudio.

B. Command Prompt finds Git, but RStudio still does not

Set the executable directly in RStudio

Go to **Tools > Global Options > Git/SVN** and browse to `C:/Program Files/Git/bin/git.exe`. Then restart RStudio.

Why two different paths?

Windows PATH commonly exposes Git through `C:\Program Files\Git\cmd`. RStudio's own Git executable setting should point directly to `C:/Program Files/Git/bin/git.exe`.

C. RStudio has Git, but you do not see a Git tab

The Git tab appears when you are working inside an RStudio Project that is also a Git repository. To test the setup, choose **File > New Project... > New Directory > New Project** and look for the option to create a Git repository, or choose **Version Control** when creating a project.

Fast diagnostic checklist

Check	What you want to see
<code>git --version</code>	A Git version number
<code>Sys.which("git")</code>	A non-empty path
RStudio > Tools > Global Options > Git/SVN	<code>C:/Program Files/Git/bin/git.exe</code>
RStudio > File > New Project...	A Version Control option

If you are still stuck

Take a screenshot of `git --version`, `where git`, `Sys.which("git")`, and the RStudio **Git/SVN** settings screen.

Source

Adapted from *Happy Git and GitHub for the useR*, especially Chapter 6 (Install Git) and Chapter 13 (Detect Git from RStudio): <https://happygitwithr.com/install-git> and <https://happygitwithr.com/rstudio-see-git>.